

SARAH SYAMKEN

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EDUCATION

Georgetown University	PhD in Spanish Linguistics (Expected Spring 2029)	Fall 2026 - Present
Georgetown University	Master of Science in Spanish Linguistics GPA: 4.00	Fall 2024 - Spring 2026
The University of Texas at Austin	Bachelor of Arts Major: Spanish Language and Culture Major: International Relations and Global Studies Minor: Portuguese Language and Culture GPA: 4.00	2019 – 2023

AREAS OF RESEARCH INTEREST

Second/Third Language Acquisition, Multilingualism, Applied Linguistics, Heritage Language Learners, Morphosyntax, Usage-Based Theory

ACADEMIC RESEARCH

Georgetown Spanish and Portuguese Qualifying Paper January 2026 - April 2026

- Title: Diverging Paths? Phonetic Development and Language Proficiency in Short-Term Study Abroad among Multilingual and Bilingual Spanish Learners
- Conducted acoustic analyses of phonetic production in bilingual and multilingual learners across two Study Abroad programs
- Developed independent proficiency in Praat, Montreal Forced Aligner, and R for speech processing, alignment, and statistical modeling

GU Graduate Research Assistantship

August 2024 - May 2025

- Advisors: Dr. Cristina Sanz and Dr. Ronald Leow
- Supported research initiatives related to projects of classroom think-aloud protocols and L2 study abroad development
- Compiled extensive literature reviews, corrected transcripts, and administered scoring of the Elicited Imitation Task

UT Spanish and Portuguese Honors Thesis – The University of Texas at Austin

January 2023 – May 2023

- Advisors: Dr. Dale Koike and Dr. Vivian Flanzer
- Title: Linguistic Typology and Cross-Linguistic Influence in L3 Brazilian Portuguese Morphology Acquisition: A Focus on Spanish Heritage Speakers in the U.S.
- Collected data from 30+ Spanish heritage speakers in an IRB-approved study at UT Austin to draw conclusions regarding the acquisition and transfer of Spanish morphological suffixes in L3 BP

Undergraduate Research – The University of Texas at Austin

Fall 2020 – Spring 2022

- Advisors: Dr. Sandro Sessarego and Piero Visconte
- Title: Racialized Speech and Media (mis)representation of Afro-Colombian Spanish

PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

- [11] *Diverging Paths? Phonetic Development and Language Proficiency in Short-Term Study Abroad among Multilingual and Bilingual Spanish Learners*, 11th Annual Spring Research Conference on Multilingual Acquisition, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya, April 2026
- [10] *Whisper through Google Colab: The Basics*, Georgetown Spanish and Portuguese LingLab, Georgetown University, January 2026
- [9] *Examining Rhotics in L3 Acquisition: Cross-Linguistic Influence in English, Spanish, and Portuguese*, GRAPHSY, Georgetown University, February 2025
- [8] *Aspects of Afro-Hispanic Speech in the Colombian Media: A Raciolinguistic Perspective*, Latinx: the Sociopolitics of Language Symposium, LSA Institute, June 2023
- [7] *Racialized speech and media (mis)representation in Afro-Colombian Spanish*, Graduate Student Conference, UT Austin, February 2023
- [6] *Influência interlinguística em respostas e reflexões de estudantes multilíngües de L3 português brasileiro*, Portuguese Flagship Program Final Capstone Presentations, Universidade Federal de São João del-Rei, Tiradentes, Brazil, December 2022

- [5] *L3 Brazilian Portuguese Creative Morphology and Cross-Linguistic Influence in Spanish Heritage Speakers and L2 Spanish Classroom Learners*, NHLRC 4th International Conference on Heritage/Community Languages, UCLA, June 2022
- [4] *Racialized speech and media representation in Afro-Colombian Spanish*, Third International Symposium on Language Attitudes toward Portuguese, Spanish and Related Languages, TAMUCC, April 2022
- [3] *Cross-Linguistic Influence and Creative Morphology in Responses and Reflections of L3 Brazilian Portuguese Learners*, Longhorn Research Poster Session 2022, University of Texas, April 2022
- [2] *L3 Brazilian Portuguese Creative Morphology and Cross-Linguistic Influence in Spanish Heritage Speakers and L2 Spanish Classroom Learners*, 9th National Symposium on Spanish as a Heritage Language, Florida State University, February 2022
- [1] *Cross-Linguistic Influence and Creative Morphology in Responses and Reflections of L3 Brazilian Portuguese Learners*, Second Language Studies Research Group, University of Texas, December 2021

TEACHING AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Language Program Director - Washington D.C. August 2026 - May 2028

- Coordinated curriculum development across multiple proficiency levels, designed assessments (quizzes, midterms, finals), and conducted classroom observations for new instructors.
- Managed course logistics, including updating Canvas templates, advising students and teaching staff, and liaising between faculty, Language Program Directors, and university administrators.

Georgetown University Graduate Teaching Assistant - Washington D.C. May 2026 - August 2026

- Supported course instruction through student consultations, written feedback and grading, and classroom instruction

Fulbright Spain English Teaching Assistant - Santiago de Compostela, Galicia, Spain September 2023 - June 2024

- Facilitated English language instruction and cultural exchange to 700+ students in Galicia, Spain, enhancing their proficiency in English and deepening their understanding of U.S. culture
- Served as a cultural ambassador in a diverse educational environment, fostering mutual understanding and cross-cultural communication between U.S. and Spanish communities

COURSES TAUGHT

Georgetown University

- Introductory Spanish I (Fall 2025)
- Introductory Spanish II (Spring 2026)
- Intermediate Spanish I (Fall 2026)

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026

Spanish and Portuguese Department Conference Travel Grant

- Graduate Scholarship for research and conference travel

Georgetown University Conference Travel Grant Award

- Graduate Scholarship for research and conference travel

2025

Curriculum Enrichment Grant - Center for New Designs in Learning and Scholarship (Georgetown University)

- Scholarship for faculty to support pedagogical innovation through culturally immersive learning activities

2023

Fulbright English Teaching Assistant (ETA) Grant Awardee

- National Grant to teach English and conduct research in Galicia, Spain

2023 University Co-op Mitchell Awards - Social Sciences Special Recognition

- University-wide award for outstanding undergraduate thesis

College of Liberal Arts Competitive Scholarship

- Merit-based scholarships for Liberal Arts students

Dean's Distinguished Graduates Nominee - Department of Spanish and Portuguese

- Merit-based honor for research, academic achievement, and leadership/service

Liberal Arts Honors Spring 2023 Research Scholarship

- Undergraduate Scholarship for research and conference travel

2022***David L. Boren Scholarship***

- Competitive Department of Defense-funded scholarship offered to study Portuguese language and culture abroad

Phi Beta Kappa – Junior Elect

- Chosen for highly selective Honors society that admits 50 out of 2000+ juniors studying liberal arts at UT

Global Career Launch Internship Scholarship

- UT Internship Abroad Program awarded to 5-10 students to pursue professional experience in Brazil

Portuguese Flagship Program Scholarship

- Awarded for a seven-month study abroad in Brazil

University of Texas Undergraduate Research Fellowship

- University-wide scholarship awarded to support conference travel

Liberal Arts Honors Upper-Division Scholarship

- Awarded for outstanding writing skills and academic merit

Marion Burke Smith Scholarship

- Awarded through Liberal Arts Honors to help support undergraduate conference travel

2021***Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Portuguese Summer Scholarship***

- Department of Education funded grant for virtual Portuguese study through UT

University of Texas Endowed Presidential Scholarship

- University-wide scholarship selected for academic merit and nominated by a faculty member

2020***Teresa Lozano Long Undergraduate Travel Scholarship***

- Scholarship awarded for study in a Spanish-speaking country (COVID-19 hindered travel to Argentina)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Co-Chair (Linguistics) for the Graduate Portuguese and Hispanic Symposium – Georgetown University August 2025 – February 2027

- Co-organized an interdisciplinary graduate conference with 80+ presenters and attendees in collaboration with a four-member organizing committee
- Reviewed and evaluated abstracts, managed conference budgets, secured external sponsorships, and coordinated on-site logistics and event planning

Social Chair - Graduate Spanish & Portuguese Student Organization – Georgetown University

August 2025 – May 2027

- Planned and executed academic and social events for a community of 50+ graduate students
- Managed and allocated an organizational budget of \$2,800, ensuring responsible use of funds and compliance with university policies

Graduate Mentor for Spanish and Portuguese Research Practicum – Georgetown University

August 2025 – December 2025

- Supported undergraduate research development through individual mentorship of two undergraduate researchers
- Trained students in practical research skills, including Python-based data processing and phonetic analysis tools such as Whisper and Montreal Forced Aligner

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Computer Skills: PRAAT, R, Qualtrics, Canvas, Canva, Colab**Languages:** Native English, Near-Native Spanish, Advanced Portuguese**Interests:** Yoga, Tennis, Stand-Up Comedy, Mexican Food